

The Boston Globe

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SATURDAY, JANUARY 17, 2026

Jews feeling brunt of hate crimes in Mass.

Antisemitic incidents highest in decades

By Matt Stout
GLOBE STAFF

For the first time, police departments in Massachusetts in 2024 recorded more hate crimes targeting Jewish people in a single year than any other group, according to a recent state report, underscoring how a yearslong rise in antisemitic incidents has taken root in the state.

Law enforcement, including local and State Police, reported 147

instances of anti-Jewish crime during 2024, the highest tally in at least two decades, according to the state government's annual hate crime reports. That marked a nearly 24 percent jump from 2023 — and the fourth straight year in which Jews and Jewish organizations were targeted more frequently than the year prior; this as the overall number of hate crime reports dipped significantly from a two-decade high in

2023.

That revealed a new, sobering conclusion: Antisemitic incidents now account for one of every four hate crime reports police take in Massachusetts.

It's also the first time, state officials noted, that incidents involving antisemitic bias outpaced all others, including hate crimes against the state's Black population, which have traditionally been the most frequently reported.

"It's a gold medal that no com-

munity wants to win," said Jeremy Burton, chief executive of the Jewish Community Relations Council of Greater Boston. "These numbers were rising before Oct. 7 two years ago. . . . I don't want to presume with every incident how much of those are . . . informed by more recent events. But it's very clear that it was building on a problem that was already there."

The state's Executive Office of Public Safety and Security released

HATE CRIMES, Page A7

Situation 'crazy,' says deported student

US apology 'makes me feel that there's still hope'

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio
GLOBE STAFF

The Babson College freshman who was abruptly deported before Thanksgiving is now calling on the Trump administration to allow her to return to the United States so she can resume her studies and reunite with her family.

Her deportation gained even wider notoriety this week after government lawyers acknowledged to a federal judge in Boston that she was mistakenly deported despite a court order forbidding her removal. The student, Any Lucia Lopez Belloza, was heartened when she heard of the government's apology, she said in an interview with the Globe.

"It makes me feel that there's still hope," Lopez Belloza, 19, said on Thursday in a phone call from Honduras, where she is now living with her grandparents.

Though Lopez Belloza said she accepts the government's apology, she has conflicting emotions.

"It also makes me kind of mad, because it's like, wow — because of your mistake, my life completely changed," she said. "I got deported. And by a mistake — it's crazy."

Meanwhile on Friday, the federal judge in her case, Richard G. Stearns, suggested the "simplest solution" would be for the State Department to

STUDENT, Page A6

Tough cookies: Anti-ICE treats hit a raw nerve

Surge in demand comes with threats at bakery

By Brooke Hauser
GLOBE STAFF

EAST LONGMEADOW — It was a sugar cookie that didn't sugarcoat the message: "F— ICE."

The Sweet Boutique, a bakery in this small town near Springfield, first posted the expletive-laden pink-and-white-frosted cookie protesting US Immigration and Customs Enforcement on Instagram a week ago, with the caption "Just girly things," and hashtags #SugarAndSpite, #NoOneIsIllegal, #FamiliesBelongTogether.

That message quickly went viral. Then came the threats — of robbery, rape, and death — against Sweet Boutique owner Niki Moran and her employees.

"I've seen a few of them," said one of the shop's college-aged baristas, sitting with two others at a cafe table inside the bakery on Friday. "Some guy said it would be a shame if the building burned down with all of us in it."

"I mean, that's a lot to hear," added her co-worker. "These people don't realize, but you're coming in here, you're flipping us off, you're getting upset with us, but we have to go home after this, or we have to go back to school and go to class."

The bakery started selling the controversial cookies two days after an ICE officer in Minneapolis shot and killed Renee Good on Jan. 7, sparking

COOKIES, Page A6

PICTURING THE BICENTENNIAL



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Lou Jones was Boston's official photographer for the Bicentennial, at a time when the city was torn by racial divisions.

50 years ago, photographer Lou Jones gave Boston a deeper look at itself

By Brian MacQuarrie
GLOBE STAFF

Old cameras, tripods, portraits on a brick wall, and stacks of narrow trays with more than a million slides are all around the eclectic East Boston home and studio of photographer Lou Jones.

He's taken pictures of Central American war zones, 13 Olympics, jazz greats, death row inmates, and 19 African countries in a decade-long, ongoing project to show the overlooked, everyday life of each nation on that continent.

And 50 years ago, as a young Black man in a city riven by racial tension, Jones was Boston's official photographer for the Bicentennial of the Amer-

BICENTENNIAL PARADE, ROXBURY



LOU JONES

Jones aimed to show what the celebration meant to marginalized groups.

ican Revolution.

"They paid me a pittance, but it completely changed my career," said Jones, who is still working at the age of 80. "It was interesting for this little nobody, and I took it to the extreme."

Instead of simply photographing handshakes and historic sites, Jones journeyed into the neighborhoods, where he took his cameras to out-of-the-way streets to show what the Bicentennial meant to ordinary and marginalized Bostonians.

As the nation celebrates its 250th anniversary, Jones's work from a half-century ago is receiving renewed attention.

A native of Washington, D.C., who moved to the South End in the late 1960s, Jones found his way to the Bi-

BICENTENNIAL, Page A10

Sooner than later, Boston accent will be no mah

By Beth Teitell
GLOBE STAFF

To even ask the question feels borderline blasphemous. But is the Boston accent — a dialect that has minted mayors, sabotaged movies, and fueled a robust industry of gift-store mugs — dying?

Has the last person to bark out *pahk the cah in Hahwahd yahd* already been born?

In December, Katherine Loftus, a proud daughter of Southie — and now a lawyer living in Milton — took to Instagram to sound the alarm.

"My kids don't have a Boston accent and it literally kills me," Loftus, 41, began in an intimate video, as she cradled a mug of coffee, her hair, makeup, and nails decidedly done, her r's decidedly missing. "They'll make fun of me. They'll be like, 'Can we go to the paaahk?'"

"It's gone. It's gone," she continued, mourning gentrification and other forces that sparked a diaspora so intense her own children are growing up in the suburbs, surrounded by friends, teachers, and others who, in her words, "talk regulah."

Regulah.

ACCENT, Page A7



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

Katherine Loftus, a proud daughter of Southie, says her kids, Gracie and Joseph, like to make fun of her accent.



Second coatings

Saturday: A bit of rain, snow. High 41-46. Low 29-34.

Sunday: More of it. High 35-40. Low 24-29.

Sunrise: 7:10 Sunset: 4:39

Weather and Comics, D4-5.

VOL. 309, NO. 17

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00



Renee Good was concerned about the actions of immigration agents in Minneapolis but wasn't "following anybody around," a lawyer said. **A2.**

Is a food hall in Fenway worth saving? Yes, Boston needs more fun places to hang out, writes Shirley Leung. **D1.**

CIA Director John Ratcliffe met with Delcy Rodríguez, the interim president of Venezuela, in Caracas this week. **A3.**

The Patriots got a boost with news that the Texans' leading receiver will not play Sunday because of a concussion. **C1.**

As it challenges an anti-pot shop ballot initiative, a pro-cannabis campaign committee filed polling data alleging misleading tactics impacted people who signed a petition. **D1.**